

Noise ALT Watch 1

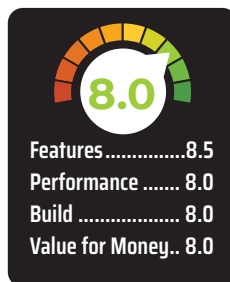
Ambitious, capable, and not without flaws

The Noise ALT Watch 1 enters a market where brands are now trying to sell an experience, and Noise wants you to buy into a design-first ecosystem backed by artificial intelligence (AI). Whether it be AI-generated watch faces or smart summaries in the mornings, the device tries hard to live up to the motto, 'this is not just another smartwatch.' Naturally, that also raises expectations, as when a brand talks extensively about AI and positions a product as a more premium alternative, we expect the experience to justify the claims beyond a presentation slide. So without any further ado, let's deep dive and check if Noise was able to deliver what it marketed.

I used the Noise ALT Watch 1 as my daily companion for some time, and I came away with mixed but largely positive impressions. The Noise ALT Watch 1 surprised me in areas I did not expect, particularly with its display, notification handling, app experience, and health-tracking reliability. However, I too have a few complaints with the device, and some of them are in a critical department. So, the question is whether those compromises matter enough to keep it off your wrist.

DESIGN AND BUILD

The first thing I noticed when I unboxed the Noise ALT Watch 1 was its circular design, which gives it a more traditional look than the square alternatives. But, beyond the looks, once I started using it regularly, I realised that the build quality did not completely match the premium image that Noise was trying to project. At Rs 5,999, I expected something that felt a little more solid



in hand. Despite featuring a metal body with an anodised aluminium bezel, the watch leans towards a plastic-heavy feel that occasionally reminds you of its price category.

That does not mean the Noise ALT Watch 1 feels poorly built. It is sturdy enough for daily use and never feels fragile, but the issue is more about perception. The marketing and design language suggest a premium experience, but the physical hardware does not always reinforce that impression.

I also took a fair amount of time to get used to the unusual crown placement. I am used to watches with a more traditional positioning of the crown, which is more towards the centre.

DISPLAY

I found the Noise ALT Watch 1's display to be quite impressive, albeit with a minor hiccup. On the good side, the 1.32-inch AMOLED panel is bright, sharp, and extremely easy to read outdoors. During my time with the

watch, visibility under direct sunlight was excellent. Whether I was checking notifications, looking at fitness stats, or simply glancing at the time while outside, the display remained clear.

This is the kind of thing that most budget and mid-range smartwatches just don't manage to get right, so it's genuinely nice to see Noise nail it. On top of that, the display barely picked up any dust or smudges, unlike most other watches I've tried in this price range.

I also put it through a proper stress test by wearing it during the daily chaos of Delhi Metro crowds, and honestly, I was a little surprised that the screen

came out without a single scratch. That's no small thing, especially since other watches I've tested in the same conditions ended up with quite a few scratches by comparison.

As for the 'minor hiccup' I earlier mentioned, I found the brightness adjustment of the device to be a bit finicky. There were occasions when the automatic brightness took slightly longer than expected to adapt to changing lighting conditions, or it never adapted unless set manually. While it was not frequent enough to become frustrating, it happened often enough for me to notice.

COMFORT

Comfort was where my experience became a little mixed, as throughout the day, the Noise ALT Watch 1 remained comfortable enough for extended wear. It never felt excessively bulky, and I was able to work, walk, and go about my routine without noticing it on my wrist.

However, the silicone strap is not my favourite type, and my judgement remains the same with the Noise ALT Watch 1. The strap tends to accumulate sweat during prolonged use, especially in the current heat of Delhi. Furthermore, with time, this makes the watch feel less comfortable than it otherwise would, and I noticed that sweat would occasionally build up around the sensor area, requiring me to clean both the strap and the watch more frequently.